

CPDO Interview — Summary, Interpretation, and Key Findings Report

Interviewee: Rhowena D. Alcantara, Officer In-Charge

Date: May 18, 2026 | 1:09 PM – 1:23 PM

Location: City Planning and Development Coordinating Office (CPDO), Bacoor City

1. Office Role and Coordination (Question 1 - *Can you briefly describe your office's role in urban planning and development in Bacoor City, particularly in relation to land use and spatial data?*)

Summary

The CPDO is now a *coordinating* office, separate from the Zoning Office which handles implementation of land use and spatial data. The CPDO formulates plans by consolidating programs, projects, and activities from various offices into documents such as the Comprehensive Land Use Plan (CLUP) and Ecological Profile. The office does not directly implement land-use controls; that falls to Zoning.

What planning documents/maps are maintained?

The CPDO maintains the CLUP, Ecological Profile, and Amended Zoning Ordinance, all of which contain hazard maps, elevation maps, barangay boundaries, and land use classifications. The official GIS-based maps are produced by the BDRRMO, which serves as the city's GIS expert.

Update frequency

The probe on how often maps are updated was not directly addressed in the interview. The officer's remarks suggest that the CLUP and zoning ordinance are now strictly enforced, but no specific update cycle (e.g., every 5 years) was mentioned.

Coordination with DRRMO

Yes. The CPDO coordinates with the BDRRMO for GIS-based maps. The officer stated that all official hazard maps, boundaries, and GIS outputs come from the BDRRMO.

The CPDO references these maps in its planning documents, indicating a functioning data-sharing relationship for flood-prone area identification.

2. Geospatial and Land Use Data Relevant to Flood-Prone Areas (Question 2 - *What geospatial or land use data does your office maintain that may be relevant to flood-prone areas in Bacoor?*)

Summary

The CPDO's CLUP and Ecological Profile contain:

- Elevation and topographic maps (visible in the CLUP)
- Flood hazard maps, storm surge maps, and other thematic hazard maps
- Land use classification (residential, commercial, etc.)

Drainage network maps

The officer discussed drainage *system rehabilitation* (dredging, desilting, waste removal) but did not confirm whether the office holds dedicated drainage network *maps*. The drainage discussion was about physical conditions, not map layers.

Land cover/land use classification

Available through the CLUP and Zoning Ordinance. The officer indicated that the Zoning Office handles land use implementation, but the CPDO can provide printed maps showing classifications.

Access for research

Researchers may obtain printed copies of maps directly from the CPDO using an existing endorsement letter from the Mayor's office. Digital GIS files (shapefiles) **will not** be released – only hardcopy print-outs or static PDF/images. The CLUP and Amended Zoning Ordinance are downloadable from the Bacoor City website, but the maps within them are static images.

3. Data Format and Accessibility (Question 3 - *In what format are these spatial data stored, and how accessible are they?*)

Summary

- **Stored formats:** GIS maps are produced in digital form by the BDRRMO, but the CPDO stores and distributes them as **hardcopy print-outs, PDF, or static images**. Shapefiles, raster datasets, and other machine-readable formats are classified as confidential and **not available** to external researchers from the CPDO.
- **Centralized GIS:** The city's centralized GIS expertise sits with the BDRRMO. The CPDO has some GIS capability but ultimately relies on the BDRRMO for official digital layers.
- **Format for researchers:** Only printed maps or static electronic copies (e.g., a PDF of the CLUP). No shapefiles, geodatabases, or raw elevation rasters will be provided.

Interpretation for FloodSense

The unavailability of shapefiles from the CPDO confirms the need to source machine-readable spatial features from open national datasets (NAMRIA, DOST-ASTI, PhilGIS) or via a separate BDRRMO data request. The CPDO maps can still serve as validation references.

4. Use of GIS and Mapping Tools (Question 4 - *Does your office use GIS or any mapping tools in your planning work? If yes, what tools or systems are used?*)

Summary

The CPDO has internal GIS capability but designates the BDRRMO as the GIS expert. The officer stated: “meron kaming GIS dito pero meron kami talagang taga-gawa, nasa BDRRMO – sila kasi yung GIS expert.” This implies the CPDO likely uses standard GIS tools (ArcGIS/QGIS) but relies on BDRRMO for finished products.

Specific tools

Not explicitly named in the transcript. Given the reference to BDRRMO's expertise and national datasets, it is reasonable to infer that the city's GIS environment includes common platforms like ArcGIS or QGIS.

National datasets referenced

The officer did not list specific agencies, but the presence of hazard, elevation, and storm surge maps strongly suggests reference to NAMRIA, DOST-ASTI, and possibly PHIVOLCS. The maps in the CLUP are likely derived from these sources.

5. Vulnerable Areas and Spatial Factors (Question 5 - *Based on your office's land use and spatial records, are there specific areas or barangays in Bacoor that you consider particularly vulnerable to flooding? What spatial factors contribute to this?*)

Summary

- **Most vulnerable barangays:** District 1 – Sinbanali, Aniban, Zapote, Talaba.

However, the officer noted that in a recent major flood event, **44 out of Bacoor's 47 barangays** experienced flooding, including areas not previously flooded.

- **Spatial factors:**
 - Bacoor is a **low-lying catch basin**; water from upland areas (Tagaytay, Imus, Dasmariñas) drains into the city.
 - **Drainage infrastructure** is inadequate and needs rehabilitation.
 - **Siltation and shallowing** of the Bacoor River, Zapote River, and Molino Dam reduce water-carrying capacity.
 - **Solid waste** clogs waterways.
- **Urbanization/land use change:** Not directly discussed, but the mention of past CLUP non-implementation implies that development occurred in flood-prone zones before current enforcement.

Interpretation

The expansion of flooding to 44 barangays underscores that susceptibility is dynamic and not confined to historically known areas – a fact that strengthens the rationale for a query-based susceptibility tool like FloodSense.

6. Biggest Gap in Using Spatial Data for Flood Risk Communication (Question 6 - *From your perspective as a planning office, what is the biggest gap in how spatial or land use data is currently used — or not used — to understand and communicate flood risk in Bacoor?*)

Summary

The officer framed the gap primarily as a **historical implementation gap**: the CLUP was not strictly enforced in the past, but it is now. This has resulted in legacy land use decisions (e.g., residential construction in unsuitable areas) that current planning is trying to correct through reclassification and enforcement.

Probes assessment

- **Underutilization in disaster risk planning:** Not directly addressed. The officer emphasized that flood is a major concern and that planning now focuses heavily on drainage projects.
- **Access by residents/officials:** The officer implied that data is available to inform plans but did not comment on whether barangay residents or officials have sufficient access. The earlier survey finding that only 20% of residents feel well-informed suggests a disconnect, but this was not raised in the interview.
- **What would make data more useful:** No specific technological or dissemination suggestions were offered. The officer pointed to the Mayor's ongoing flood-mitigation projects as the primary response.

Interpretation for FloodSense

The gap identified (CLUP enforcement) is primarily regulatory, not digital. The interview reveals an opportunity that the CPDO did not articulate: making the rich spatial data they already hold (even if only as map images) more interactive and accessible to the public. This aligns with FloodSense's aim to bridge the communication gap between institutional data and community awareness.

Key Findings

1. **Data exists but is not machine-readable for researchers:** The CPDO holds elevation, hazard, land use, and barangay boundary maps, but only as hardcopy or static images. GIS shapefiles are confidential and will not be released.
2. **BDRRMO is the GIS custodian:** All official digital spatial layers are produced and held by the BDRRMO, though the CPDO uses them in planning documents.
3. **Request pathway is simple:** An endorsement letter from the Mayor's office allows direct access to CPDO hardcopy maps; no further routing is required.
4. **Vulnerable areas are more extensive than historical records imply:** District 1 is the perennial hotspot, but recent flooding affected 44 of 47 barangays, proving that flood susceptibility is widespread and dynamic.
5. **Contributing factors are systemic:** Catch-basin topography, river/dam siltation, drainage inadequacy, and solid waste are the main spatial and environmental drivers.
6. **Update frequency not specified:** The frequency of CLUP/map updates was not addressed.
7. **Communication gap remains unaddressed:** The CPDO did not identify a specific digital communication gap, but the contrast with the 20% resident awareness figure highlights a need for tools like FloodSense.

8. **No drainage network GIS layer confirmed:** The office discussed drainage infrastructure condition but did not confirm the existence of GIS-based drainage network maps available for research.